

Seminar *Truthmaker Semantics* (Kit Fine)

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On the Ontology of Truthmakers

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The questions addressed

- Can truthmaker semantics be neutral regarding the ontology of truthmakers?
- What conditions on the ontology of truthmakers does truthmaker semantics impose?
- How do the ontological assumptions about truthmakers in truthmaker semantics compare to those of the older tradition of truthmaking (metaphysical truthmaking)?
- Can states or situations as entities composed of relations and arguments serve as semantic truthmakers?
- Can events and tropes as fully specific entities be suited for exact truthmaking?
- How do actions, on monist and pluralist views fare with respect to truthmaking in the semantic and the metaphysical sense?
- How do completions of relations (as discussed in current metaphysics of relations) fare as truthmakers in the semantic or metaphysical sense.

The topics

1. Two views of truthmaking: semantic truthmaking and metaphysical truthmaking
2. Truthmaking in truthmaker semantics: semantic truthmaking
3. The older notion of truthmaking: metaphysical truthmaking
4. Challenges for exact truthmaking: the general issue
5. Events as truthmakers?
6. Other kinds of entities as truthmakers
 - 6.1. Actions as truthmakers
 - 6.2. Planned events as truthmakers
 - 6.3. Stative verbs and truthmaking
 - 6.4. Completion of relations as truthmakers

1. Two views of truthmaking: semantic truthmaking and metaphysical truthmaking

Semantic truthmaking

Truthmaking serves a primarily semantic purpose.

What truthmakers are is decided by their semantic role.

Truthmaker semantics can stay neutral regarding the nature of truthmakers (?)

Truthmakers make up the denotation of sentences and include merely possible entities.

Truthmakers serve to define the notion of aboutness, partial truth and partial content.

Metaphysical truthmaking:

Truthmaking serves the interest of grounding the truth of sentences in reality.

A truthmaker is an entity in virtue of which a true sentence is true.

2. Truthmaking in truthmaker semantics: semantic truthmaking

Situation-based semantics in general

The denotation of a sentence is the set of situations in which it is true.

Earlier views (Situation Semantics)

(1) The notion of inexact truthmaking

If a situation s makes a sentence S true, then also any situation s' , $s < s'$, makes S true (Monotonicity).

Truthmaker semantics

(2) Exact truthmaking

A situation s is an exact truthmaker of a sentence S ($s \Vdash S$) iff s makes S true and s is wholly relevant for the truth of S .

Fine's notion of a state (instead of 'situation'):

'state' – any entity suited to play the truthmaker role.

What sorts of conditions does TMS impose on the ontology of truthmakers?

1. Compositionality

All sentences have truthmakers (and perhaps falsity makers).

The truthmakers of a sentence S are obtained compositionally on the basis of the semantic values of expressions that make up S .

2. Part relation among situations

Part relation: partial order, closed under sum formation (fusion)

Partial truth

(1) A sentence is *partially true* iff for an exact truthmaker s of S , there is an actual, non-null situation s' , $s' < s$.

Partial content

(2) A set of situations A is a *partial content* of a set of situation B if for every s in A , there is an s' in B , $s < s'$, and for every s in B , there is an s' in A , $s' < s$.

Aboutness (subject matter)

(3) The *subject matter* of a sentence S is the fusion of the set of truthmakers of S (and the set of falsitymakers of S).

Assumption about the part structure of truthmakers

The set of states (situations) is partially ordered by the part relation $<$ and closed under fusion.

Question

What sorts of things are the parts of truthmakers?

Truthmaker semantics imposes just one condition: parts of truthmakers need to again be truthmakers.

What are the parts of situations?

The structured view of situations (e.g., situation semantics):

Situations are n -tuples consisting of a relation and its arguments and perhaps a polarity.

Objects and properties thus are constituents of situations.

But can truthmaker semantics have objects and properties count as parts of situations?

No, otherwise:

(4) *John likes Mary* is partially true because John exists (and John in fact dislikes Mary).

The requirement imposed by truthmaker semantics

Situations have as parts only subsituations.

(Note that the morpheme *sub* means ‘part of, while being of the same kind’.

Other examples: subevent, subinterval, subplurality, subcommittee)

Other cases where things contained in others do not count as parts

Pluralities - individuals - parts of individuals

(5) a. part of the cats - their tails?

b. part of the people - their heads?

Structured wholes:

(5) c. parts (plural) of the book - the pages - parts of the pages?

d. part (mass) of the library – the encyclopedia – the pages of the encyclopedia?

A common move

Distinguish different part relations applying to pluralities and individuals (Link, Simons, ...):

Part relation P_1 ordering pluralities individuals (Link’s i-part relation)

Part relation P_2 ordering parts of individuals

Individuals are atoms with respect to P_1 , but not P_2 .

The move is inapplicable to structured wholes like books and libraries!

Application to situations

Situations making atomic sentences true are atoms – with respect to the part-relation posited by truthmaker semantics (Jago 2022, p. 10).

This also accounts for why subsituations like the situation that John exists cannot make *John likes Mary* true.

Problems

(6) a. *The students passed the exam* is partly true:

eight out of the ten students passed the exam.

b. *John walked to the house* is partly true – John jumped to the house.

c. *John read the paper* is partly true, he had a quick look at it.

d. *They destroyed the sculpture* is partly true:

they knocked off the head (but nothing else).

Does the notion of a situation as an atom even make sense?

Does it make sense as a linguistically relevant notion?

Does it make sense as a notion regarding the actual metaphysics of situations?

Proposal for distinguishing the subsituations in (6) from the subsituation in which John exists as part of a truthmaker of John likes Mary (Kit Fine's suggestion in the seminar):

The situation in which John exists is a background part of the situation in which John likes Mary and as such has a different status than the subsituations in (6).

But background situations representing presuppositions raise issues themselves, e.g., fusion of situations does not involve an order, but presuppositions of sentences do.

3. The older notion of truthmaking: metaphysical truthmaking

Fundamental intuition about truth

The truth of sentences should be grounded in reality.

Philosophers endorsing metaphysical truthmaking:

Armstrong (1997), Mulligan / Simons / Smith (1984), Rodriguez-Pereyra (2005), Restall (1996), among others.

Various attempted definitions of metaphysical truthmaking (McBride / Daly 2025)

(6) Truthmaking according to Armstrong (1997):

The relation between an entity *s* and a sentence *S* such that the existence of *s* necessitates the truth of *S*.

Deriving metaphysical truthmaking from the grounding of truth (Rodriguez-Pereyra (2005)

Given that grounding is a relation between a sentence and something else, there needs to be an entity which grounds the truth of a sentence, that is, in virtue of which the sentence is true.

Comment

This is a questionable argument:

'*a* is grounded in *b*' does not entail that there is a specific part *b'* of *b*, such that *b* grounds *a*.

Compare:

There is a misunderstanding in the book does not entail that there is a specific part of the book containing the misunderstanding, rather the book overall may be based on a misunderstanding.

Similarly, *The Mafia boss lives in Sicily* can be true if there is no specific place in Sicily where the boss live, but he moved around temporary residences constantly.

Thus, *the truth of S is grounded in reality* can be true if the sentence is true in virtue of reality overall.

The metaphysical notion is sometimes used for inexact truthmaking; sometimes for exact truthmaking.

Defense of exact truthmaking (Rodriguez-Pereyra 2005)

‘A truthmaker should strictly consist only of features in virtue of which a sentence is true. E. g., *John is walking* is made true by a walking event of John, but not by an event that is a walking and yawning of John or an event that is a walking of John and Mary’.

Question: what are ‘features’ – Entities? Tropes?

Applying metaphysical truthmaking to natural language semantics?

‘The idea of truthmaking is a controversial, but often discussed, idea in contemporary metaphysics. It has rarely been explored for the purpose of natural language semantics, though. At the same time, it is not clear that it can truly be applied in linguistic semantics.’ (Moltmann 2013, p. 89).

The use of the metaphysical notion for semantics

Moltmann (2007), later rejected in Moltmann (2013), and again partially adopted in Moltmann (2019).

Exact truthmaking

If the metaphysical notion of truthmaking is used for the semantics of nominalizations, this requires exact truthmaking:

John’s happiness could not possibly refer to a trope involving any properties on the part of John not constitutive of John’s being happy

Likewise for the semantics of adverbial modification:

John is profoundly happy could not possibly be understood as “John is happy and John and Mary’s happiness was profound.”

What sorts of objects can the worldly objects be that act as metaphysical truthmakers?

1. Armstrong (1997):
States of affairs as parts of the world.
2. Mulligan / Simons / Smith (1984):
‘Moments’ – a category of entities that including events and tropes, and material objects:

Examples

Tropes as truthmakers: John’s happiness

(7) John is happy.

Events as truthmakers: John’s walk

(8) John was walking.

Objects as truthmakers:

(9) a. There was a man in the park.

b. John is a man.

The decision of what the truthmaker of a sentence are will come from ‘below’, rather than from semantic considerations.

What distinguishes the metaphysical notion of truthmaking from the semantic one

1. Not all sentences need to have metaphysical truthmakers.
Strong version of metaphysical truthmaker theory:
Every true sentence needs to have a truthmaker (Armstrong 1997, Restall 1996).
Weak version:
Not all true sentences need to have a truthmaker, e.g., not negative sentences (Mulligan/Simons /Smith 1984).
2. Truthmakers are independent of compositional semantics, may enter various complex relations to the sentence

Semantic application of metaphysical truthmaking (Moltmann 2007)

1. Adnominal and averbial modifiers as predicates of truthmakers:
(10) a. John is profoundly happy.
b. $\exists t(t \models \text{John is happy} \ \& \ \text{profound}(t))$

(11) a. John walked slowly.

b. $\exists t(t \models \text{John walked} \ \& \ \text{slow}(t))$

(12) a John's slow walk

b. $\max e: e \models \text{John walked slowly}$

2. Stacked adverbials as predicates of an entity that “incorporates” the contribution of another adverbial modifier:

(13) a. The ball suddenly rolled quickly.

b. $\exists e(e \models \text{The ball suddenly rolled quickly} \text{ iff}$

$\exists e'(e' \models \text{The ball rolled quickly} \ \& \ e \models \langle \text{SUDDEN}, e' \rangle))$

In (13a), truthmaking obtains between an event and a structured proposition.

(13a) involves three truthmakers:

- the event of the ball's rolling (the truthmaker of the proposition that the ball rolled)
- the event of the ball's quick rolling (the truthmaker of the proposition that the ball rolled quickly)
- the suddenness of the ball's quick rolling (the truthmaker of the entire sentence).

3. Adverbials taking scope over universal quantifier

(14) a. John carefully corrected all the mistakes

b. $e \models \text{John carefully corrected every mistake}$ iff there is an event e' such that:

$e \models ([\text{carefully}], e') \ \& \ e' \models \text{John corrected every mistake}$

4. Negation

(15) a. John did not correct the mistake.

b. $e \models \text{John did not correct the mistake}$ iff $e \models \neg \text{John corrected the mistake}$.

Advantages of applying (metaphysical) truthmaking to adverbial and adnominal modification

1. captures well the intuition that a simple subject–predicate sentence such as *John is happy* is just about John, not “John's happiness.” “John's happiness” comes to play a semantic role only via the truthmaking relation.
2. The truthmaking relation allows the referent of *John's happiness* to be a concrete entity, more specific than the description used to refer to it, without, though, acting as an implicit argument of the predicate.

Problems with the application of metaphysical truthmaking to semantics

1. Partial and total adjectives (Yoon 1996)

The truthmaker of a sentence may have to be identified in different ways for partial and total adjectives.

Clean ‘absence of any dirt’ – *dirty* ‘presence of some dirt’

Straight ‘absence of a bent’ – *bent* ‘presence of a bent’

Whole – *broken*

Even – *uneven*

Perfect – *flawed*

The difficulty: different truthmakers for total and partial adjectives:

- Sentences with total adjectives have ‘allness’ condition as truthmaker (if any)
- Sentences with partial adjective have as truthmaker a particular ‘disturbance’ (with part of the subject referent as bearer)
- Sentences with other adjectives (*happy*, *foreign* etc) have as truthmakers tropes (of various sorts) with the entire subject reference as bearer as truthmakers.

Consequence

No uniform semantics of predication (with adjectives) based on metaphysical truthmaking.

Semantic truthmaking

Is unproblematic since it comes with a uniform semantics:

Sentences of the form ‘NP *is* A’ always have states as truthmakers, whatever states may be.

A more general difficulty applying metaphysical truthmaking to adjectives:

With partial and total adjectives, the truthmaking conditions arguably form part of the lexical content of the adjectives that is part of the speakers’ linguistic competence. However, in many cases the condition the predicate imposes on the truthmaker may not be part of a competent speaker’s knowledge of language. A predicate may turn out to be negative (requiring the absence of tropes of a certain sort) or quantificational, depending on the outcome of science, without any speaker yet knowing that. Metaphysical truthmaking then would be inapplicable.

4. Challenges for exact truthmaking: The general issue

What sorts of things are exact truthmakers?

‘State’ is a technical notion, stands for whatever plays the semantic truthmaker role

‘Situation’ is a semitechnical notion, without clear ontological content:

different views of what situations are, what sorts of entities situations comprise, and how situations are composed.

General assumption about truthmakers shared by both the semantic and the metaphysical version

Truthmakers are parts of the world (possible worlds), and as such should be fully specific.

Fully specific entities as entities ‘in’ the world: events, tropes, states (in a concrete sense)

Contrast with entities obtained by abstraction as entities ‘at’ the world, e.g., facts as the obtaining of a relation of objects

A useful criterion for full specificity: predicates of description (Moltmann 2007)

Predicates of description are applicable to tropes and events, but not facts:

(16) a. Mary described John’s happiness.

b. Mary’s described John’s walk.

b. ??? Mary described John’s being happy / the fact that John was happy.

Abstract objects can be fully specific or not

(17) a. the straightness of the line (specific) – a trope with an abstract object as bearer

b. the line’s being straight (unspecific) – a fact about an abstract object

Is the requirement of full specificity a problem for exact truthmaking?

No:

distinguish what is relevant for truthmaking from what is needed for making a sentence true

(22) a. John is a doctor

b. John is a gynecologist.

A state as part of the world should be fully specific, but being a gynecologist is more specific than is needed for the truth of (22a).

However, being a gynecologist is relevant for the truth of being a doctor.

Thus, (22a) and (22b) should have the same truthmakers.

6. Events as truthmakers?

Davidsonian event semantics (Davidson 1967):

(26) a. John walked slowly.

b. $\exists e(\text{walk}(e, \text{John}) \ \& \ \text{slowly}(e))$

Truthmaker-based event semantics:

(27) $\exists e' \exists e(e \Vdash \text{John walked} \ \& \ e' \Vdash \text{<SLOWLY, } e\text{>})$

Are events too specific for the truthmaking role?

Yes:

De Silva (2025, p. 264):

‘(...) let us consider the view of truthmakers as events. It seems plausible that events can explain the truth and falsity of at least some sentences (...) the event of John buttering the toast seems to make it true that “John buttered the toast”, providing the required explanation for its truth. However, we are dealing with exact truthmaker semantics and therefore looking for an entity that could be the exact truthmaker for this sentence. And while we could describe this situation as an event of John buttering the toast, we would probably be leaving out lots of details about the event that would be irrelevant for the truth of “John buttered the toast”, such as how long John took, with what hand he did it, what brand of butter (if any) he used, how burnt the toast was, etc. All of these details would be part of any event of John buttering the toast, yet they are all irrelevant information for determining the truth of “John buttered the toast”. ‘

Moltmann (2019, p. 360):

‘The alternative, truthmaker account would do away with the Davidsonian argument position of verbs, adjectives, as well as adverbials. While this gives justice to an intuition that the semantics of those expressions is simpler than the Davidsonian would have it, there are reasons to in fact not pursue the truthmaker account in that way. Given the relation of exact truthmaking, events, like any other fully individuated entities (including tropes), appear unsuited for the exact truthmaking relation (...). Events generally have more properties than are needed for the exact truthmaking of sentences. Take the sentence *John is walking*. A

concrete event of John's walking has a location, a manner, an intensity, possibly a company, and other features not relevant for the truth of *John is walking*. That is, events, like tropes and enduring objects, are too thick to serve as exact truthmakers. Thus, there is reason not to apply Truthmaker Semantics to the semantics of nominalizations and simpler adverbial constructions (...).

There are, arguably, entities, though, that we refer to in natural language that serve the exact truthmaker role, namely 'cases', entities we refer to as *the case in which John might be walking, the case in which John does not get up before 8, the case in which John eliminates every mistake*, etc. (...). But 'cases' have very different properties from events. In fact, they have a lot fewer properties than events, lacking, generally, a location, a temporal part structure and causal roles (...). Take 'the case in which John does not get up: which would be the exact truthmaker of the sentence John does not get up. That case cannot be located in Germany, does not have temporal parts (if any in fact), and cannot make Mary fall asleep again. That is, unlike events it lacks a spatial location, temporal parts, and causal roles.

Despite the difficulties with a truthmaker-based semantics for nominalizations and simple adverbial modification, the truth maker-based semantics appears the only option and in fact an entirely appropriate one for adverbial modification of quantified and negated sentences. This means that the Davidsonian semantics of event (and trope) nominalizations as well as simpler adverbial constructions should best be combined with a truthmaker account of more complex constructions involving adverbials and complex nominalizations.'

Cases as truthmakers (Moltmann 2021)

- (28) a. The cases in which John did not get up.
b. Sum s (s John did not get up)

Do the same intuitions obtain for tropes?

- (29) a. Mary is happy.
b. The vase is heavy.
c. Socrates is wise.

Mary's happiness, John's nervousness, Socrates' wisdom – do they contain features irrelevant for the truth of (29a – c)?

Obervation: tropes do not come with a direct location (Moltmann, to appear)

- (30) a. ??? Socrates' wisdom was in Athens
 b. ??? The vase's heaviness is on the table.

Are tropes thus better suited for the truthmaker role than events?

In general tropes seem to come with fewer property dimensions than events.

Another observation:

Events are multidimensional regarding their part structure, but not so tropes

- (31) The clouds have completely disappeared.

Two readings:

- Every cloud has disappeared
- The clouds have reached the highest degree of invisibility

- (32) The glasses are completely transparent.

One reading:

- The glasses manifest the highest degree of transparency.

Tropes are one-dimensional, strictly 'focused' on the property they instantiate.

Are tropes therefore unproblematic as truthmakers?

Again, distinguish what is needed for the truthmaking of a sentence from what is relevant.

Exact truthmaking asks for what is relevant, not for what is needed.

But what are the criteria for relevance?

Truthmaker semantics takes relevance to be primitive.

Let us assume that events are too specific for the purpose of truthmaking.

Can the exact truthmaking relation be modified to account for such truthmakers?

Suggestion

Events that are exact truthmakers do not have (separable) parts that are irrelevant for the truth of the sentence.

Irrelevant features of events (locations, manners etc.) are not (separable) parts of events.

- (33) Modified definition of exact truthmaking

A concrete object *s* is an exact truthmaker of *S* iff *s* makes *S* true and there is no proper part of *s* that is irrelevant for the truth of *S*.

Modification of exact truthmaking is suited for the usual application of exact truthmaking:

The fusion of John's walk and Mary's laughter is not an exact truthmaker of *John walked*.

6. Other kinds of entities as truthmakers

6.1. Actions as truthmakers

Fine 's (2018) application of truthmaker semantics to commands (imperatives):

Actions as truthmakers (satisfiers) and falsity makers (violators):

Imperatives are complied with by actions and can be violated by actions.

Actions:

Concrete, agent-dependent, involve intention

The discussion of actions in Fine (1982, 2022)

Typical act descriptions:

(34) John's act of destroying the chair

Acts are individuated in part in terms of conceptual contents:

Different truth conditions:

(35) a. The act of killing the mayor was intentional.

b. The act of killing the neighbor was intentional.

Fine: 'Act' serves an intentional operator.

Observations:

The complement (modifier) of *act* is clausal, rather than nominal (imperfect nominals), just like fact descriptions:

(36) a. the act of destroying the chair

b. ?? the act of the destroying of the chair

Fact descriptions

(37) a. John's being happy

b. the fact that John is happy

c. John's destroying the chair

d. the fact that John destroyed the chair

The by-relation or level-generation among acts

Movement of the finger - pulling the trigger - firing a shot - killing of the mayor

Pluralism (e.g., Goldman, Fine): different actions involved

Monism (e.g., Anscombe): the same action involved

Question

Do the two views of monism and pluralism bear on truthmaking?

Metaphysical truthmaking

The movement of the finger is not enough: does not necessitate the truth of the sentence (if that is how truthmaking is defined)

Exact truthmaking:

Is the movement of the finger wholly relevant for the killing the mayor? Certainly not.

But also:

The killing of the mayor does not have the lower-level acts as essential components.

(38) The killing of the mayor could have been done in a different way.

Conclusion

The status of actions with respect to truthmaking raises so far unanswered questions.

6.2. Planned events as truthmakers?

Ardisson et al. (2025):

- Planned events such as ceremonies, demonstrations, projects are ontologically distinct from basic (Davidsonian) events, such as accidents, spontaneous laughter.
- Planned events as basic events qua realizing a plan.

Distinctive properties of planned events (ceremonies, demonstrations, projects)

Planned events allow for predicates of participation, replacement, and completion, and the existence predicate *take place*, but not so basic events.

Their concrete realizations are not treated as essential to planned events:

(39) The ceremony could have taken place in a different way.

What does this mean for truthmaking?

Semantic truthmaking

Truthmakers as realized plans, rather than just particular realizations (basic events)

Metaphysical truthmaking (grounding of truth)

Truthmaking at the level of realization?

6.3. Stative predicates and truthmaking

The distinction between concrete and abstract states (Maienborn 2007, Moltmann 2013)

- Concrete states typically are states of bodily positions
- Most stative verbs describe abstract states, which lack a spatial location, a manner, a particular manifestation.
- Abstract states are on a par with facts, and thus are not ‘in’ , but ‘at’ the world.

Motivation for abstract states:

Most stative verbs do not permit adverbials of location or manner:

- (40) a. ??? John owes Mary ten dollar in New York
 b. ??? John owns a stamp collection in Munich.
 c. ??? John resembles Mary in Germany / with a lot of effort.

Copula verbs:

- (41) a. ??? John is tall in Berlin / without effort.
 b. ??? John is nervous in his car.

Mulligan/Simons/ Smith (1984)

The truthmaker of *John is nervous* is a trope – John’s nervousness.

Maienborn (2007):

Copula *be* describes an abstract state: John’s being nervous.

This raises an issue for semantic truthmaking:

The truthmaker of *John is nervous* then should be an abstract state, but abstract states are not part of the world (and not fully specific).

Metaphysical truthmaking:

No problem positing John’s nervousness as the truthmaker of *John is nervous*, since truthmaking is independent of compositionality.

Another case: comparatives

(42) Mount Everest is taller than Mont Blanc.

Semantic truthmaker:

The state of ME being taller than MB – an abstract state!

Metaphysical truthmakers:

The height of Mount Everest and the height of Mont Blanc – two tropes

McBride (SEP ‘Relations’): distinguish between ontological commitment and truthmakers

Ontological commitment: internal relation between Mount Everest and Mont Blanc

Internal relation explains why the truthmakers, the heights of the two mountains, make the sentence true.

Overall conclusion

Stative sentences (with abstract state verbs) present serious challenges to semantic truthmaking as they do not permit an identification of concrete entities (tropes or similar entities) as semantic truthmakers.

Abstract states, being on a par with facts, are not suited for truthmaking.

6.4. Completions of relations as truthmakers

Neutral relations (Fine 2000)

Binary relations completed as situations or states of affairs are neutral, not involving a direction or order among the arguments

Are such completions suited as semantic truthmakers?

This would mean that (43a) and (43b) have the same truthmakers:

(43) a. John saw Mary.

b. Mary was seen by John.

But what if completions need to be built compositionally (first completion by object referent (for one theta role) then by subject referent (for another theta role))?

Also, if *by*-phrases are adjuncts, this may make a difference to the situation described.

Another case: double-object alternations

(44) a. John gave the book to Mary.

b. John gave Mary the book.

Different theta-roles for to Mary and Mary (goal vs. beneficiary)

Plural slot theory (Dixon 2018)

Symmetric relations are in fact plural properties.

Does this mean that (45a) and (45b) have the same semantic truthmakers?

(45) a. John is similar to Bill.

b. John and Bill are similar.

(46) a. John is a neighbor of Bill.

b. John and Bill are neighbors.

This seems implausible given any reasonable subsentential compositional truthmaker semantics.

Related puzzle

Selling and buying, teaching and learning – the same relations, the same completions by entities?

Positionalism

Relations are associated with distinct positions, but without an order among them

Theta roles in generative syntax

Names for argument positions and aligned syntactic positions; presupposes positionalism (unless it is cast within Neo-Davidsonian event semantics)

Truthmaker semantics

Access to individual positions is needed for compositional semantics.

Truthmaker semantics needs to be compositional below the sentence level.

Suggestion

There are two levels of completions of relations:

1. syntax-based completions
2. metaphysical completions

Question:

Do the two forms of completion match semantic and metaphysical truthmaking?

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